

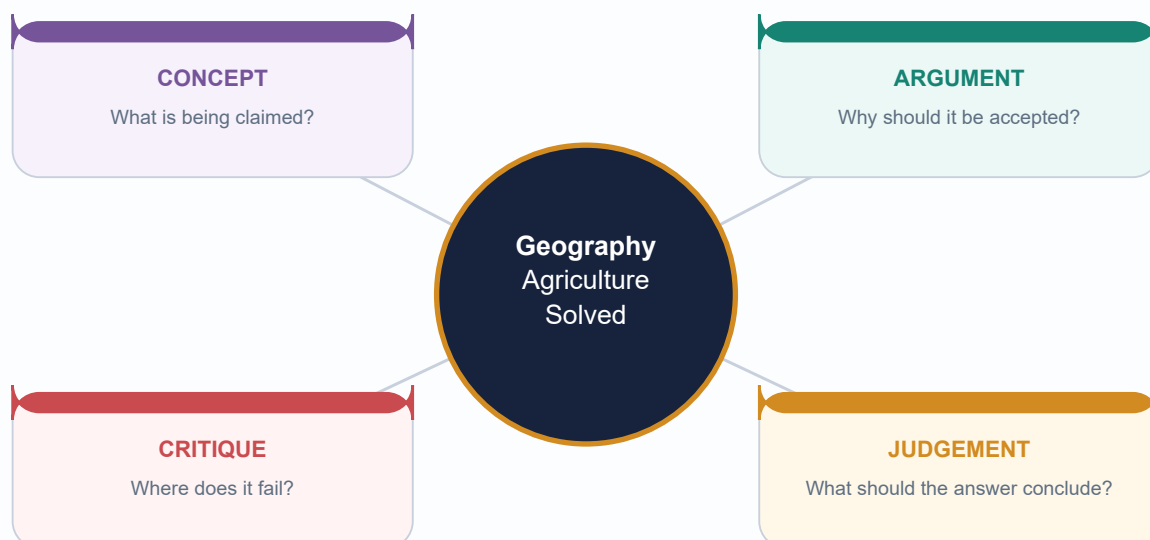
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Geography 30 - Agriculture: Solved Workbook

All locally routed direct PYQs plus cross-topic agriculture PYQs

Strict MCQ key rotation A -> B -> C -> D

Export date: 19 August 2026



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Workbook evidence and answer-key protocol

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

All listed PYQs are verified against repository-local official UPSC scans or routing ledgers derived from them. Objective questions without a local official key retain the mandatory inferred-answer label.

WORKBOOK EVIDENCE AND ANSWER-KEY PROTOCOL

Current-Data and Status Firewall

Schematic; not to scale

QUANTITATIVE FIREWALL

advance estimate != final estimate
area x yield ~= production; reconciliation matters
production != procurement != stock
MSP announcement != procurement coverage
crop year != marketing year != FY
foodgrains != cereals; oilseeds separate

ADMINISTRATIVE FIREWALL

lakh tonnes != million tonnes
cotton bale = 170 kg; jute bale = 180 kg
horticulture has separate estimate rounds
potential created != utilised/reliable irrigation
registration != unique active farmer/impact
forecast != realised seasonal outcome

Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- The 2025 turmeric item uses the local official Set-A key and separately flags its tension with dated PIB statements.
- Mains wording is lightly normalised from the official English scan or the verified routing ledger; year, paper, number, directive and mark demand are preserved.
- Every model solution uses claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict -> why this earns marks.
- Original MCQ keys rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D without consecutive repetition.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Retrieval date 19 August 2026.
2. No coaching answer key is represented as official.

UPSC TRAPS**WRONG:** Missing key means omit PYQ.**CORRECT:** Retain it with inference, confidence and elimination logic.**MAINS ANGLE***Workbook protocol.***STUDY LINK**

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**UPSC Prelims 2019 Q21 - New World crops**
GS-I & GS-III
Geography
NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which group of plants was domesticated in the New World and introduced into the Old World? A Tobacco, cocoa and rubber; B Tobacco, cotton and rubber; C Cotton, coffee and sugarcane; D Rubber, coffee and wheat.

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: A. Confidence: high.
- Tobacco, cacao and the rubber tree are New World domesticates. Coffee and wheat are Old World; cotton has multiple domestication centres, so options containing coffee/wheat or an ambiguous cotton bundle are eliminated.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: Each statement is tested independently, the key status is explicit and the elimination logic is tied to crop geography or primary evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: A. Confidence: high.

UPSC TRAPS**WRONG:** Answer status omitted.**CORRECT:** Official and inferred keys must be visibly different.**MAINS ANGLE***Solved objective PYQ.***STUDY LINK**

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**UPSC Prelims 2020 Q87 - frost-free subtropical crop**
GS-I & GS-III
Geography
NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

A subtropical crop is injured by hard frost, needs at least 210 frost-free days, 50-100 cm rainfall and light well-drained moisture-retentive soil. Identify it: A Cotton; B Jute; C Sugarcane; D Tea.

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: A. Confidence: high.
- The long frost-free season with moderate rainfall and a light, well-drained moisture-retentive soil is the classic cotton requirement bundle. Jute and tea require more humid conditions; sugarcane has a different water-duration profile.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: Each statement is tested independently, the key status is explicit and the elimination logic is tied to crop geography or primary evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: A. Confidence: high.

UPSC TRAPS**WRONG:** Answer status omitted.**CORRECT:** Official and inferred keys must be visibly different.**MAINS ANGLE***Solved objective PYQ.***STUDY LINK**

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**UPSC Prelims 2022 Q62 - tea-producing states**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Among Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Himachal Pradesh and Tripura, how many are generally known as tea-producing States? A one; B two; C three; D all four.

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: D. Confidence: high.
- Kerala, Himachal Pradesh and Tripura have recognised tea sectors, and Andhra Pradesh has tea cultivation including the Araku/Eastern Ghats context. The missing local official key prevents upgrading the answer to official status.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: Each statement is tested independently, the key status is explicit and the elimination logic is tied to crop geography or primary evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: D. Confidence: high.

UPSC TRAPS**WRONG:** Answer status omitted.**CORRECT:** Official and inferred keys must be visibly different.**MAINS ANGLE***Solved objective PYQ.***STUDY LINK**

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH

UPSC Prelims 2023 Q4 - India-China agriculture comparison

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Statements: India has more arable area than China; India's proportion of irrigated area is higher; India's average productivity per hectare is higher. How many are correct? A one; B two; C all three; D none.

STATIC THEORY

- INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: B. Confidence: medium-high.

- The first two comparative statements are defensible under the data vintage used by the question, while India's average agricultural productivity per hectare is not higher than China's. Cross-country definitions and reference years are the main caution.

- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: Each statement is tested independently, the key status is explicit and the elimination logic is tied to crop geography or primary evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: B.
Confidence: medium-high.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Answer status omitted.

CORRECT: Official and inferred keys must be visibly different.

MAINS ANGLE

Solved objective PYQ.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH

UPSC Prelims 2025 Q24 - turmeric, official key conflict

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Statements for 2022-23: India is the largest producer and exporter of turmeric; more than 30 varieties are grown; Maharashtra, Telangana, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu are major producers. Options: A I-II; B II-III; C I-III; D I-II-III.

STATIC THEORY

- OFFICIAL SET-A KEY: B (statements II and III only).

- The local official UPSC key unambiguously records B. However, dated PIB material describes India as the world's largest producer, consumer and exporter and supports statements II and III. The package preserves the official key and flags the unresolved primary-source contradiction rather than inventing a reconciliation.

- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: Each statement is tested independently, the key status is explicit and the elimination logic is tied to crop geography or primary evidence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. OFFICIAL SET-A KEY: B (statements II and III only).

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Answer status omitted.

CORRECT: Official and inferred keys must be visibly different.

MAINS ANGLE

Solved objective PYQ.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2018 GS-I Q15**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

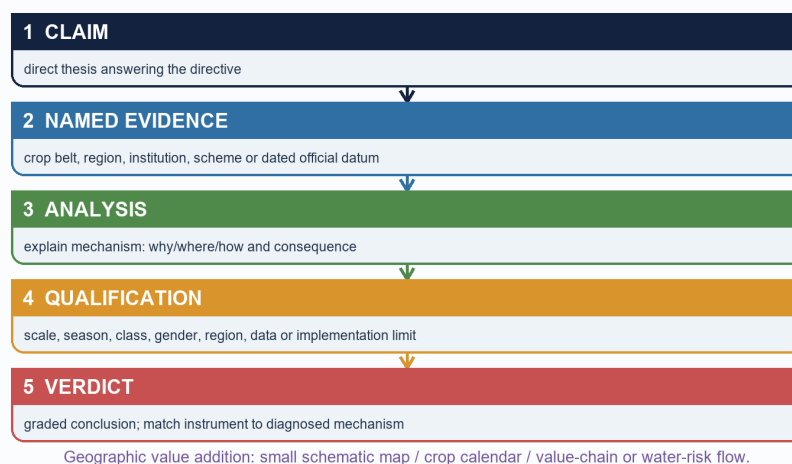
Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Define the Blue Revolution and explain problems and strategies for pisciculture development in India.

VERIFIED SOLVED MAINS PYQ - 2018 GS-I Q15**UPSC Agriculture Answer Spine**

Schematic; not to scale



Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Define fisheries/aquaculture expansion, distinguish capture from culture, map inland/coastal potential, and evaluate seed-feed-disease-water-market constraints.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: India's floodplains, reservoirs and ponds show that fish geography is not coastal only. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: PM Matsya Sampada-type value-chain logic: seed, feed, health, landing, cold chain and market. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Coastal aquaculture illustrates export potential with disease, salinity and habitat risks. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Do not reduce Blue Revolution to a slogan or a production number.
- VERDICT: A region-specific, biosecure and cold-chain-linked fisheries strategy can diversify rural income without externalising ecological costs.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 2018 GS-I Q15

UPSC TRAPS**WRONG:** Generic narrative.**CORRECT:** Use named spatial evidence and directive fidelity.**MAINS ANGLE***Direct Geography owner PYQ.***STUDY LINK**

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2022 GS-I Q15****GS-I & GS-III**
Geography**NEWS TRIGGER**

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

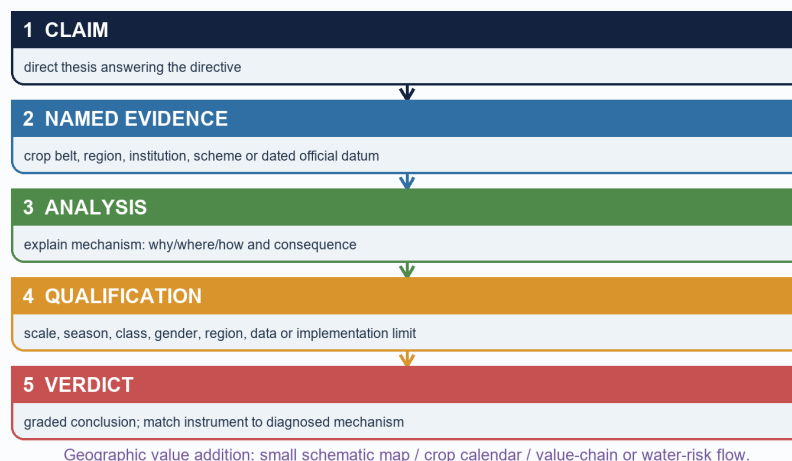
INTRO & ORIGIN

Describe the distribution of rubber-producing countries and indicate major environmental issues faced by them.

VERIFIED SOLVED MAINS PYQ - 2022 GS-I Q15

UPSC Agriculture Answer Spine

Schematic; not to scale



Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Locate humid tropical South-East and South Asia, parts of Africa and Latin America; explain heat-rainfall and plantation-processing geography.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Thailand, Indonesia, Vietnam and Malaysia illustrate the South-East Asian core.
ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: India's classic belt is Kerala with suitable expansion pockets in the North-East.
ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Plantation expansion can replace diverse forests, simplify habitats and create chemical/soil impacts. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Natural-rubber distribution also reflects colonial planting, labour, disease and processing, not climate alone.
- VERDICT: Sustainable rubber requires yield improvement on existing land, diversified agroforestry and traceable value chains.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 2022 GS-I Q15

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Generic narrative.**CORRECT:** Use named spatial evidence and directive fidelity.

MAINS ANGLE

Direct Geography owner PYQ.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH

Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2023 GS-I Q17

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

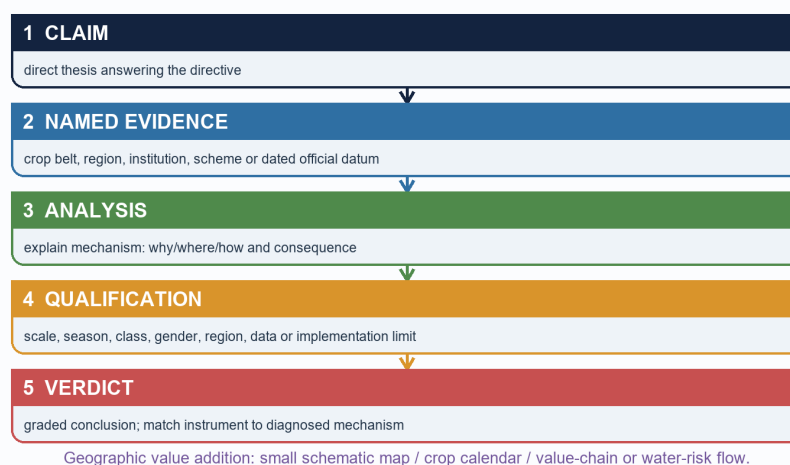
INTRO & ORIGIN

Give reasons for India's movement from net food importer in the 1960s to net food exporter.

VERIFIED SOLVED MAINS PYQ - 2023 GS-I Q17

UPSC Agriculture Answer Spine

Schematic; not to scale



Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Explain technology plus institutions: irrigation, HYVs, research, credit, procurement, storage, roads and later diversification.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Punjab-Haryana-western UP supplied the early Green Revolution surplus. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FCI/central-pool procurement converted regional surplus into national food management. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Later gains in rice, wheat, horticulture, livestock and fisheries broadened output. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Net export is commodity- and year-specific and does not prove universal nutritional security or sustainable water use.
- VERDICT: India's transition was an institutional-spatial transformation; future security requires diversified, climate-resilient and resource-aligned productivity.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 2023 GS-I Q17

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Generic narrative.

CORRECT: Use named spatial evidence and directive fidelity.

MAINS ANGLE

Direct Geography owner PYQ.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH

Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2025 GS-I Q5

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

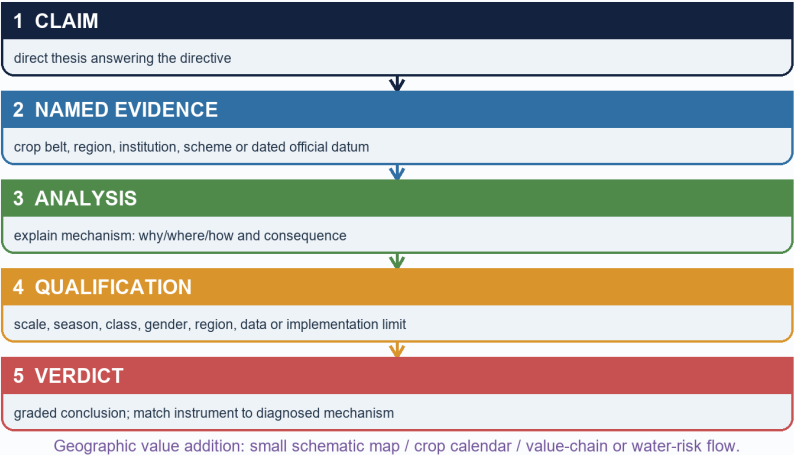
INTRO & ORIGIN

What are non-farm primary activities? How are these related to physiographic features in India?

VERIFIED SOLVED MAINS PYQ - 2025 GS-I Q5

UPSC Agriculture Answer Spine

Schematic; not to scale



Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Define and explicitly exclude manufacturing; cover fishing, forestry, mining and quarrying.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Western shelf/upwelling and estuaries shape marine fishing; floodplains/reservoirs shape inland fishery. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Climate, altitude and access shape Himalayan, central Indian and north-eastern forestry/NTFP systems. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Peninsular shields, sedimentary basins, lateritic caps and riverbeds govern mining/quarrying occurrence. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Physiography sets occurrence and potential, while transport, technology, rights and regulation determine realised use.
- VERDICT: India's non-farm primary geography is the economic expression of its geological, fluvial, coastal and ecological diversity.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 2025 GS-I Q5

UPSC TRAPS**WRONG:** Generic narrative.**CORRECT:** Use named spatial evidence and directive fidelity.**MAINS ANGLE***Direct Geography owner PYQ.***STUDY LINK**

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2018 GS-III Q3 (10 marks)****GS-I & GS-III**
Geography**NEWS TRIGGER**

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss how MSP can protect farmers from low-income traps.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: MSP can reduce downside price risk only when the signal is credible at the farmer's market.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: CACP recommendation and CCEA announcement establish the national signal. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FCI/state procurement in rice-wheat belts shows how purchase makes the signal effective. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Pulses/oilseeds show weaker and more episodic procurement geography. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: MSP does not address yield loss, rising cost, tiny marketed surplus or non-farm household risk.
- VERDICT: Use crop- and region-specific procurement with storage, diversification and risk instruments rather than treating MSP as universal income policy.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: MSP and procurement.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2018 GS-III Q4 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Examine the role of supermarkets in agricultural supply chains and whether they eliminate intermediaries.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Agricultural-marketing performance depends on functions, competition and infrastructure rather than the legal identity of the intermediary.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: e-NAM demonstrates digital price discovery but still requires assaying, logistics and settlement. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FPOs aggregate small lots and bargaining power but need working capital and governance. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Warehouse receipts and cold chains reduce distress sale and quality loss when accredited and connected. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: A large private buyer can replace a commission agent yet reproduce monopsony and quality-dispute risk.
- VERDICT: Reform should combine market choice, trusted grading, farmer aggregation, finance, logistics and enforceable contracts.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: markets.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2018 GS-III Q8 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss ecological and economic benefits of Sikkim as an organic state.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Ecological farming can reduce external input and soil-water pressure while creating differentiated transition costs.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Sikkim provides a named whole-state organic-policy example. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: NPOP/PGS-type certification distinguishes standard-based organic from generic low-input practice. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Diversified rotations, manure and biological processes can improve soil functions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Certification, market premium and lower chemical use do not guarantee yield, income or zero externality in every crop and season.
- VERDICT: Phase transitions with extension, local nutrient plans, markets and outcome monitoring.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: sustainability.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2018 GS-III Q13 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Assess the role of the National Horticulture Mission in production and farmer income.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: High-value horticulture can raise value per hectare and employment only when perishability and market risk are managed.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Mission-linked nurseries, planting material and cluster support strengthen the production base. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Packhouses, cold chains and processing convert biological output into saleable quality. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FPOs and contracts can aggregate produce and connect buyers. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: A high gross value can coexist with high cost, rejection, price crash and post-harvest loss.
- VERDICT: Choose crops by agro-climate, water, market, logistics and household risk rather than price expectation alone.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: horticulture.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2018 GS-III Q14 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Elaborate changes in cropping pattern and the emphasis on millet production.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Cropping patterns respond to agro-climate and relative expected returns shaped by procurement, consumption, technology and value chains.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Rice-wheat procurement and irrigation created path dependence in the north-west. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Millets offer dryland, nutrition and climate advantages in suitable regions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Pulses/oilseeds and horticulture require seed, processing, storage and market support. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Diversification can shift water or price risk rather than reduce it when alternative chains are weak.
- VERDICT: Align price, procurement, water, processing and insurance signals with regional agro-ecology.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: cropping.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2019 GS-III Q3 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss how Integrated Farming Systems sustain agricultural production.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Integrated Farming Systems stabilise smallholder livelihoods by linking crop, livestock, fish and trees through material and income flows.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Crop residues feed livestock and manure returns nutrients. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Farm ponds can support protective irrigation and fish where ecologically suitable. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Multiple enterprises spread seasonal labour and market risk. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Management, labour, animal health, water and market complexity can exceed smallholder capacity.
- VERDICT: Promote locally designed enterprise combinations with extension, biosecurity and FPO/value-chain support.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: integrated.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2019 GS-III Q4 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Elaborate the impact of watershed development on water-stressed agriculture.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: India's agricultural water crisis is a source-distribution-application-drainage-governance problem, not only a shortage of projects.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: PMKSY separates access, efficiency and watershed/command functions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Drip/sprinkler can raise plot efficiency; basin saving depends on rebound. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Watershed ridge-to-valley treatment supports recharge and protective irrigation. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: The groundwater-power nexus in north-western and hard-rock regions shows shared-stock externality. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Potential created or area covered does not prove reliable, equitable and sustainable irrigation.
- VERDICT: Combine aquifer budgeting, crop-water alignment, energy reform, canal maintenance, drainage and participatory allocation.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: water.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2019 GS-III Q5 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss the contributions of M. Visvesvaraya and M.S. Swaminathan to water engineering and agricultural science.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Agricultural transformation emerged from complementary engineering, crop science and state institutions.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Visvesvaraya's automatic sluice gates and block irrigation illustrate systematic water engineering. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Swaminathan's role in adapting semi-dwarf wheat/rice links global germplasm to Indian agronomy. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Punjab-Haryana-western UP show the package of water, fertiliser, credit, extension and procurement. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Success was regionally selective and generated groundwater, nutrient and crop-lock-in costs.
- VERDICT: Retain research and state capacity while shifting to diversified, resource-aligned and rainfed productivity.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: green.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2019 GS-III Q13 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss reforms needed to make foodgrain distribution effective.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Food security requires availability, access, utilisation and stability; procurement and PDS are linked but distinct institutions.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FCI/state procurement converts surplus into central-pool stocks. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: NFSA/TPDS creates a legal entitlement channel. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: ONORC/digitisation improve portability and auditability. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Buffer stocks support emergencies and price management. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Cereal access cannot alone solve nutrition, exclusion, storage loss or ecological production costs.
- VERDICT: Improve dynamic coverage, grievance routes, storage, diversified baskets and transparent stock-release rules.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: food.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2019 GS-III Q14 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Elaborate policy responses to food-processing-sector challenges.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Food processing connects farm geography to consumer markets by extending shelf life, standardising quality and creating derived demand.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Milk cooperatives show aggregation-processing-cold-chain integration. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Fruit/vegetable packhouses and cold chains reduce quality decay. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: AIF and MoFPI-type infrastructure support can crowd in storage and processing. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Processing can concentrate buyer power, water use, waste and low-quality jobs if regulation and local linkages are weak.
- VERDICT: Build clusters around resource suitability, farmer organisations, logistics, skills, quality and circular waste use.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: processing.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2020 GS-III Q3 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What are the constraints in transport and marketing of agricultural produce?

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Agricultural-marketing performance depends on functions, competition and infrastructure rather than the legal identity of the intermediary.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: e-NAM demonstrates digital price discovery but still requires assaying, logistics and settlement. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FPOs aggregate small lots and bargaining power but need working capital and governance. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Warehouse receipts and cold chains reduce distress sale and quality loss when accredited and connected. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: A large private buyer can replace a commission agent yet reproduce monopsony and quality-dispute risk.
- VERDICT: Reform should combine market choice, trusted grading, farmer aggregation, finance, logistics and enforceable contracts.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: markets.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2020 GS-III Q4 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What are the challenges and opportunities of food processing for raising farmer income?

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Food processing connects farm geography to consumer markets by extending shelf life, standardising quality and creating derived demand.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Milk cooperatives show aggregation-processing-cold-chain integration. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Fruit/vegetable packhouses and cold chains reduce quality decay. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: AIF and MoFPI-type infrastructure support can crowd in storage and processing. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Processing can concentrate buyer power, water use, waste and low-quality jobs if regulation and local linkages are weak.
- VERDICT: Build clusters around resource suitability, farmer organisations, logistics, skills, quality and circular waste use.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: processing.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2020 GS-III Q6 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

How has agricultural technology changed farming and everyday life?

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Digital agriculture improves observation, coordination and transaction only when data are accurate and services remain accessible and contestable.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Digital Agriculture Mission provides the umbrella. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: AgriStack federates farmer, map and crop-sown information with states. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Krishi-DSS and remote sensing support monitoring. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: e-NAM, digital claims and advisories connect production to markets/risk. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Land-linked registries may exclude tenants and women; model inference can be wrong; connectivity and correction matter.
- VERDICT: Pair digital public infrastructure with assisted access, privacy, ground truth, reasons and appeal.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: digital.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2020 GS-III Q8 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain water-conservation and security features of Jal Shakti Abhiyan.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: India's agricultural water crisis is a source-distribution-application-drainage-governance problem, not only a shortage of projects.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: PMKSY separates access, efficiency and watershed/command functions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Drip/sprinkler can raise plot efficiency; basin saving depends on rebound. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Watershed ridge-to-valley treatment supports recharge and protective irrigation. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: The groundwater-power nexus in north-western and hard-rock regions shows shared-stock externality. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Potential created or area covered does not prove reliable, equitable and sustainable irrigation.
- VERDICT: Combine aquifer budgeting, crop-water alignment, energy reform, canal maintenance, drainage and participatory allocation.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: water.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2020 GS-III Q13 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What explains the success of the rice-wheat system, and what negative consequences followed?

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Agricultural transformation emerged from complementary engineering, crop science and state institutions.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Visvesvaraya's automatic sluice gates and block irrigation illustrate systematic water engineering. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Swaminathan's role in adapting semi-dwarf wheat/rice links global germplasm to Indian agronomy. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Punjab-Haryana-western UP show the package of water, fertiliser, credit, extension and procurement. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Success was regionally selective and generated groundwater, nutrient and crop-lock-in costs.
- VERDICT: Retain research and state capacity while shifting to diversified, resource-aligned and rainfed productivity.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: green.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2020 GS-III Q14 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Suggest measures to improve water storage and irrigation under depletion.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: India's agricultural water crisis is a source-distribution-application-drainage-governance problem, not only a shortage of projects.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: PMKSY separates access, efficiency and watershed/command functions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Drip/sprinkler can raise plot efficiency; basin saving depends on rebound. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Watershed ridge-to-valley treatment supports recharge and protective irrigation. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: The groundwater-power nexus in north-western and hard-rock regions shows shared-stock externality. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Potential created or area covered does not prove reliable, equitable and sustainable irrigation.
- VERDICT: Combine aquifer budgeting, crop-water alignment, energy reform, canal maintenance, drainage and participatory allocation.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: water.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2021 GS-III Q3 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

How did land reforms affect marginal and small farmers?

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Land reform succeeds when legal design, records, mobilisation and administration alter the cultivator's actual rights and incentives.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Operation Barga recorded sharecroppers. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Kerala and early J&K illustrate stronger reform under distinct political conditions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Agriculture Census separates operated from owned area. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Consolidation and clear leasing can improve investment and scale. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Ceiling evasion, exemptions, informal tenancy and fragmentation limited impact; one state model is not universally transferable.
- VERDICT: Complete the rights-records-leasing-consolidation chain while protecting tenants, women and smallholders.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: land.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2021 GS-III Q4 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

How far can micro-irrigation solve India's water crisis?

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: India's agricultural water crisis is a source-distribution-application-drainage-governance problem, not only a shortage of projects.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: PMKSY separates access, efficiency and watershed/command functions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Drip/sprinkler can raise plot efficiency; basin saving depends on rebound. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Watershed ridge-to-valley treatment supports recharge and protective irrigation. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: The groundwater-power nexus in north-western and hard-rock regions shows shared-stock externality. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Potential created or area covered does not prove reliable, equitable and sustainable irrigation.
- VERDICT: Combine aquifer budgeting, crop-water alignment, energy reform, canal maintenance, drainage and participatory allocation.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: water.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2021 GS-III Q13 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What are the salient features of NFSA 2013, and how has it addressed hunger?

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Food security requires availability, access, utilisation and stability; procurement and PDS are linked but distinct institutions.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FCI/state procurement converts surplus into central-pool stocks. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: NFSA/TPDS creates a legal entitlement channel. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: ONORC/digitisation improve portability and auditability. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Buffer stocks support emergencies and price management. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Cereal access cannot alone solve nutrition, exclusion, storage loss or ecological production costs.
- VERDICT: Improve dynamic coverage, grievance routes, storage, diversified baskets and transparent stock-release rules.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: food.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2021 GS-III Q14 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What are the challenges of crop diversification and opportunities from emerging technologies?

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Cropping patterns respond to agro-climate and relative expected returns shaped by procurement, consumption, technology and value chains.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Rice-wheat procurement and irrigation created path dependence in the north-west. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Millets offer dryland, nutrition and climate advantages in suitable regions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Pulses/oilseeds and horticulture require seed, processing, storage and market support. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Diversification can shift water or price risk rather than reduce it when alternative chains are weak.
- VERDICT: Align price, procurement, water, processing and insurance signals with regional agro-ecology.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: cropping.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2022 GS-III Q3 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss PDS challenges and measures for effectiveness and transparency.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Food security requires availability, access, utilisation and stability; procurement and PDS are linked but distinct institutions.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FCI/state procurement converts surplus into central-pool stocks. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: NFSA/TPDS creates a legal entitlement channel. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: ONORC/digitisation improve portability and auditability. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Buffer stocks support emergencies and price management. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Cereal access cannot alone solve nutrition, exclusion, storage loss or ecological production costs.
- VERDICT: Improve dynamic coverage, grievance routes, storage, diversified baskets and transparent stock-release rules.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: food.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2022 GS-III Q4 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Elaborate the scope and significance of food processing in India.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Food processing connects farm geography to consumer markets by extending shelf life, standardising quality and creating derived demand.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Milk cooperatives show aggregation-processing-cold-chain integration. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Fruit/vegetable packhouses and cold chains reduce quality decay. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: AIF and MoFPI-type infrastructure support can crowd in storage and processing. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Processing can concentrate buyer power, water use, waste and low-quality jobs if regulation and local linkages are weak.
- VERDICT: Build clusters around resource suitability, farmer organisations, logistics, skills, quality and circular waste use.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: processing.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2022 GS-III Q13 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss upstream and downstream bottlenecks in agricultural marketing.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Agricultural-marketing performance depends on functions, competition and infrastructure rather than the legal identity of the intermediary.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: e-NAM demonstrates digital price discovery but still requires assaying, logistics and settlement. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FPOs aggregate small lots and bargaining power but need working capital and governance. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Warehouse receipts and cold chains reduce distress sale and quality loss when accredited and connected. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: A large private buyer can replace a commission agent yet reproduce monopsony and quality-dispute risk.
- VERDICT: Reform should combine market choice, trusted grading, farmer aggregation, finance, logistics and enforceable contracts.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: markets.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2022 GS-III Q14 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain benefits of Integrated Farming Systems for small and marginal farmers.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Integrated Farming Systems stabilise smallholder livelihoods by linking crop, livestock, fish and trees through material and income flows.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Crop residues feed livestock and manure returns nutrients. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Farm ponds can support protective irrigation and fish where ecologically suitable. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Multiple enterprises spread seasonal labour and market risk. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Management, labour, animal health, water and market complexity can exceed smallholder capacity.
- VERDICT: Promote locally designed enterprise combinations with extension, biosecurity and FPO/value-chain support.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: integrated.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2023 GS-III Q3 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain how e-technology helps farmers in production and marketing.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Digital agriculture improves observation, coordination and transaction only when data are accurate and services remain accessible and contestable.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Digital Agriculture Mission provides the umbrella. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: AgriStack federates farmer, map and crop-sown information with states. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Krishi-DSS and remote sensing support monitoring. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: e-NAM, digital claims and advisories connect production to markets/risk. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Land-linked registries may exclude tenants and women; model inference can be wrong; connectivity and correction matter.
- VERDICT: Pair digital public infrastructure with assisted access, privacy, ground truth, reasons and appeal.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: digital.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2023 GS-III Q4 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss land-reform objectives, measures and land-ceiling policy.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Land reform succeeds when legal design, records, mobilisation and administration alter the cultivator's actual rights and incentives.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Operation Barga recorded sharecroppers. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Kerala and early J&K illustrate stronger reform under distinct political conditions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Agriculture Census separates operated from owned area. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Consolidation and clear leasing can improve investment and scale. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Ceiling evasion, exemptions, informal tenancy and fragmentation limited impact; one state model is not universally transferable.
- VERDICT: Complete the rights-records-leasing-consolidation chain while protecting tenants, women and smallholders.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: land.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2023 GS-III Q13 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain cropping-pattern changes driven by consumption and marketing.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Cropping patterns respond to agro-climate and relative expected returns shaped by procurement, consumption, technology and value chains.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Rice-wheat procurement and irrigation created path dependence in the north-west. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Millets offer dryland, nutrition and climate advantages in suitable regions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Pulses/oilseeds and horticulture require seed, processing, storage and market support. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Diversification can shift water or price risk rather than reduce it when alternative chains are weak.
- VERDICT: Align price, procurement, water, processing and insurance signals with regional agro-ecology.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: cropping.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2023 GS-III Q14 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss Indian farm subsidies and WTO disputes on agricultural support.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Farm support must be classified by design and trade effect rather than by domestic policy label.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: WTO amber box captures trade-distorting support subject to commitments. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Green box requires specified non/minimally trade-distorting design. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Blue box links support to production-limiting programmes. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Public stockholding debates show the interaction of administered prices and food security. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: A measure can serve legitimate livelihood/food-security goals and still face notification or calculation disputes.
- VERDICT: Improve transparent notification, targeted decoupled support and a durable food-security solution while protecting policy space.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: wto.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2024 GS-III Q3 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Elaborate factors behind successful land reforms in parts of India.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Land reform succeeds when legal design, records, mobilisation and administration alter the cultivator's actual rights and incentives.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Operation Barga recorded sharecroppers. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Kerala and early J&K illustrate stronger reform under distinct political conditions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Agriculture Census separates operated from owned area. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Consolidation and clear leasing can improve investment and scale. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Ceiling evasion, exemptions, informal tenancy and fragmentation limited impact; one state model is not universally transferable.
- VERDICT: Complete the rights-records-leasing-consolidation chain while protecting tenants, women and smallholders.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: land.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2024 GS-III Q4 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain the role of millets in health and nutritional security.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Cropping patterns respond to agro-climate and relative expected returns shaped by procurement, consumption, technology and value chains.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Rice-wheat procurement and irrigation created path dependence in the north-west. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Millets offer dryland, nutrition and climate advantages in suitable regions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Pulses/oilseeds and horticulture require seed, processing, storage and market support. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Diversification can shift water or price risk rather than reduce it when alternative chains are weak.
- VERDICT: Align price, procurement, water, processing and insurance signals with regional agro-ecology.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: cropping.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2024 GS-III Q13 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

State challenges of the Indian irrigation system and government measures.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: India's agricultural water crisis is a source-distribution-application-drainage-governance problem, not only a shortage of projects.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: PMKSY separates access, efficiency and watershed/command functions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Drip/sprinkler can raise plot efficiency; basin saving depends on rebound. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Watershed ridge-to-valley treatment supports recharge and protective irrigation. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: The groundwater-power nexus in north-western and hard-rock regions shows shared-stock externality. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Potential created or area covered does not prove reliable, equitable and sustainable irrigation.
- VERDICT: Combine aquifer budgeting, crop-water alignment, energy reform, canal maintenance, drainage and participatory allocation.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: water.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2024 GS-III Q14 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Elucidate the importance of buffer stocks for price stabilisation and storage challenges.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Food security requires availability, access, utilisation and stability; procurement and PDS are linked but distinct institutions.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FCI/state procurement converts surplus into central-pool stocks. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: NFSA/TPDS creates a legal entitlement channel. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: ONORC/digitisation improve portability and auditability. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Buffer stocks support emergencies and price management. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Cereal access cannot alone solve nutrition, exclusion, storage loss or ecological production costs.
- VERDICT: Improve dynamic coverage, grievance routes, storage, diversified baskets and transparent stock-release rules.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: food.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2025 GS-III Q3 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain factors influencing farmers' selection of high-value crops.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: High-value horticulture can raise value per hectare and employment only when perishability and market risk are managed.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Mission-linked nurseries, planting material and cluster support strengthen the production base. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Packhouses, cold chains and processing convert biological output into saleable quality. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FPOs and contracts can aggregate produce and connect buyers. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: A high gross value can coexist with high cost, rejection, price crash and post-harvest loss.
- VERDICT: Choose crops by agro-climate, water, market, logistics and household risk rather than price expectation alone.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: horticulture.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2025 GS-III Q4 (10 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Elaborate the scope and significance of supply-chain management of agricultural commodities.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Agricultural-marketing performance depends on functions, competition and infrastructure rather than the legal identity of the intermediary.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: e-NAM demonstrates digital price discovery but still requires assaying, logistics and settlement. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FPOs aggregate small lots and bargaining power but need working capital and governance. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Warehouse receipts and cold chains reduce distress sale and quality loss when accredited and connected. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: A large private buyer can replace a commission agent yet reproduce monopsony and quality-dispute risk.
- VERDICT: Reform should combine market choice, trusted grading, farmer aggregation, finance, logistics and enforceable contracts.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 10 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: markets.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2025 GS-III Q13 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Examine factors behind groundwater depletion and government steps.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: India's agricultural water crisis is a source-distribution-application-drainage-governance problem, not only a shortage of projects.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: PMKSY separates access, efficiency and watershed/command functions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Drip/sprinkler can raise plot efficiency; basin saving depends on rebound. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Watershed ridge-to-valley treatment supports recharge and protective irrigation. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: The groundwater-power nexus in north-western and hard-rock regions shows shared-stock externality. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Potential created or area covered does not prove reliable, equitable and sustainable irrigation.
- VERDICT: Combine aquifer budgeting, crop-water alignment, energy reform, canal maintenance, drainage and participatory allocation.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: water.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Verified solved Mains PYQ - 2025 GS-III Q14 (15 marks)**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Examine the scope of food processing and its employment potential.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Food processing connects farm geography to consumer markets by extending shelf life, standardising quality and creating derived demand.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Milk cooperatives show aggregation-processing-cold-chain integration. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Fruit/vegetable packhouses and cold chains reduce quality decay. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: AIF and MoFPI-type infrastructure support can crowd in storage and processing. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Processing can concentrate buyer power, water use, waste and low-quality jobs if regulation and local linkages are weak.
- VERDICT: Build clusters around resource suitability, farmer organisations, logistics, skills, quality and circular waste use.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Verified local official-paper demand; 15 marks.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Use an Economy-only scheme list.

CORRECT: Retain the geographic lens: region, flow, resource, scale and inequality.

MAINS ANGLE

Cross-routed agriculture PYQ: processing.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 1 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement best separates intensive from commercial farming?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Intensive concerns input/output per unit land, while commercial concerns market orientation.
- B. Intensive always means mechanised.
- C. Commercial always means extensive.
- D. Both are climatic classifications.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- EXPLANATION: Intensive concerns input/output per unit land, while commercial concerns market orientation.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 2 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which condition most directly steepens a Von Thunen rent gradient?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Uniform fertility.
- B. High transport cost or rapid quality decay per unit distance.
- C. Many substitute markets.
- D. Lower perishability.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- EXPLANATION: High transport cost or rapid quality decay per unit distance.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 3 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Boserup's central claim is best expressed as:

STATIC THEORY

- A. Population growth always reduces output.
- B. Land abundance automatically raises yields.
- C. Population pressure can induce intensification under enabling institutional and technical conditions.
- D. Technology is unrelated to labour.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- EXPLANATION: Population pressure can induce intensification under enabling institutional and technical conditions.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 4 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is an operational holding?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Only legally owned land.
- B. Only irrigated land.
- C. Every parcel in one village.
- D. All land operated as one technical unit for agricultural production, regardless of ownership mix.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- EXPLANATION: All land operated as one technical unit for agricultural production, regardless of ownership mix.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 5 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which comparison is correct?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Market gardening is often peri-urban; truck farming can serve distant markets through transport.
- B. Both are subsistence systems.
- C. Truck farming is nomadic.
- D. Market gardening excludes vegetables.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- EXPLANATION: Market gardening is often peri-urban; truck farming can serve distant markets through transport.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 6 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is the strongest groundwater-energy nexus explanation?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Power subsidy directly recharges aquifers.
- B. Low marginal pumping cost encourages extraction from a shared aquifer, raising future lift and energy needs.
- C. Every well draws an isolated stock.
- D. Deeper water lowers energy use.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- EXPLANATION: Low marginal pumping cost encourages extraction from a shared aquifer, raising future lift and energy needs.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

- WRONG:** Choose the longest option.
CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 7 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What does a crop calendar add to annual climate averages?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Only market price.
- B. Only soil texture.
- C. Stage-specific exposure to sowing moisture, flowering heat, frost, flood and harvest rain.
- D. A fixed national sowing date.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- EXPLANATION: Stage-specific exposure to sowing moisture, flowering heat, frost, flood and harvest rain.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 8 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is not a synonym of the other two?

STATIC THEORY

- A. All prohibit tillage.
- B. All require certification.
- C. All prohibit synthetic input in every design.
- D. Organic, natural and conservation agriculture are distinct frameworks with partial overlap.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- EXPLANATION: Organic, natural and conservation agriculture are distinct frameworks with partial overlap.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 9 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which chain is statistically valid?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Area x yield approximately relates to production, subject to harvested area, units and official reconciliation.
- B. Production equals procurement.
- C. Stock equals consumption.
- D. MSP equals market arrival.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- EXPLANATION: Area x yield approximately relates to production, subject to harvested area, units and official reconciliation.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

- WRONG:** Choose the longest option.
- CORRECT:** Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 10 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why can micro-irrigation fail to save basin water?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Drip cannot deliver water.
- B. Farmers may expand irrigated area or shift to more water-intensive crops.
- C. Sprinklers always cause salinity.
- D. Efficiency has no physical meaning.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- EXPLANATION: Farmers may expand irrigated area or shift to more water-intensive crops.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 11 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What is the best test of e-NAM impact?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Farmer registration alone.
- B. Number of app downloads.
- C. Completed competitive trade with credible assaying, settlement and farmer price/cost outcomes.
- D. Number of listed commodities alone.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- EXPLANATION: Completed competitive trade with credible assaying, settlement and farmer price/cost outcomes.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 12 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is correctly paired?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Foodgrains: rice and wheat only.
- B. Oilseeds: part of pulses.
- C. Cereals: includes gram.
- D. Foodgrains: cereals plus pulses; oilseeds: separate official aggregate.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- EXPLANATION: Foodgrains: cereals plus pulses; oilseeds: separate official aggregate.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 13 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which best explains plantation geography?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Crop ecology plus estate labour, processing, capital and port/export history.
- B. Perennial life cycle alone.
- C. Subsistence destination.
- D. Absence of market links.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- EXPLANATION: Crop ecology plus estate labour, processing, capital and port/export history.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 14 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about shifting cultivation is balanced?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It is always sustainable.
- B. Outcome depends on fallow length, slope, crop diversity, tenure and fire management.
- C. It is always destructive.
- D. It is a plantation system.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- EXPLANATION: Outcome depends on fallow length, slope, crop diversity, tenure and fire management.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 15 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why is procurement geography narrower than production geography?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Only one state produces grain.
- B. MSP is announced for one district.
- C. Agency operations, crop concentration, quality, infrastructure and state capacity vary spatially.
- D. Production requires a warehouse.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- EXPLANATION: Agency operations, crop concentration, quality, infrastructure and state capacity vary spatially.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 16 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

What does climate-smart agriculture denote?

STATIC THEORY

- A. One certification standard.
- B. Only genetically modified seed.
- C. A ban on irrigation.
- D. A context-specific objective of productivity, adaptation/resilience and mitigation where feasible.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- EXPLANATION: A context-specific objective of productivity, adaptation/resilience and mitigation where feasible.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 17 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about PMFBY is most accurate?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It insures specified notified crop risks under scheme rules; it is not universal farm-income insurance.
- B. It guarantees MSP.
- C. It covers every individual loss identically.
- D. It removes weather risk.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- EXPLANATION: It insures specified notified crop risks under scheme rules; it is not universal farm-income insurance.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 18 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is a valid Green Revolution conclusion?

STATIC THEORY

- A. The package was seed alone.
- B. Food-security gains and regional/ecological externalities must be assessed together.
- C. It was uniform across India.
- D. Procurement played no role.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- EXPLANATION: Food-security gains and regional/ecological externalities must be assessed together.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 19 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which best distinguishes stock from flow?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Both are annual production.
- B. Both are consumer demand.
- C. Central-pool stock is inventory at a date; procurement is purchase over a period.
- D. Neither has units.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- EXPLANATION: Central-pool stock is inventory at a date; procurement is purchase over a period.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 20 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which high-value-crop decision is most robust?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Follow last year's peak price.
- B. Ignore cold chain.
- C. Assume contract removes risk.
- D. Match agro-climate, reliable water, perishability, buyer, logistics, finance and household risk.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- EXPLANATION: Match agro-climate, reliable water, perishability, buyer, logistics, finance and household risk.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 21 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about FPOs is correct?

STATIC THEORY

- A. They can aggregate scale, but governance, capital and buyer competition determine results.
- B. They automatically abolish APMC.
- C. They are all legally identical cooperatives.
- D. They guarantee export.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- EXPLANATION: They can aggregate scale, but governance, capital and buyer competition determine results.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

- WRONG:** Choose the longest option.
- CORRECT:** Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 22 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is a valid data-governance principle for AgriStack?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Farmer ID creates title.
- B. Federation and interoperability still require purpose limits, correction, assisted access and appeal.
- C. Model output is legally infallible.
- D. Tenants are automatically represented.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- EXPLANATION: Federation and interoperability still require purpose limits, correction, assisted access and appeal.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A → B → C → D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Economic Geography →
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 23 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which best explains yield gap?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It is identical to income gap.
- B. It is always caused by seed.
- C. The difference between attainable and realised yield can reflect ecology, management, risk and access.
- D. It ignores weather.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- EXPLANATION: The difference between attainable and realised yield can reflect ecology, management, risk and access.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A → B → C → D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Economic Geography →
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 24 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about horticulture data is correct?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It is included in foodgrains.
- B. It has no area data.
- C. It is always final.
- D. It is released through separate estimate rounds and should not be merged casually with DES foodgrain estimates.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- EXPLANATION: It is released through separate estimate rounds and should not be merged casually with DES foodgrain estimates.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

- WRONG:** Choose the longest option.
- CORRECT:** Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 25 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is a just-transition concern?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Crop shifts can impose stranded skills, assets and income risk on smallholders, tenants and labour.
- B. Only national output matters.
- C. Tenure is irrelevant.
- D. All farmers can switch instantly.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- EXPLANATION: Crop shifts can impose stranded skills, assets and income risk on smallholders, tenants and labour.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A → B → C → D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Economic Geography →
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 26 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is the best answer-ending verdict on sustainable agriculture?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Adopt one technique nationally.
- B. Use a region-specific portfolio matched to diagnosed soil, water, risk, market and justice constraints.
- C. Ban all technology.
- D. Maximise yield alone.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- EXPLANATION: Use a region-specific portfolio matched to diagnosed soil, water, risk, market and justice constraints.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A → B → C → D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Economic Geography →
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 27 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which pairing is correct?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Both 100 kg.
- B. Cotton 180 kg and jute 170 kg.
- C. Cotton bale: 170 kg; jute/mesta bale: 180 kg in the DES table.
- D. Bales equal tonnes.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- EXPLANATION: Cotton bale: 170 kg; jute/mesta bale: 180 kg in the DES table.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 28 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which stage is strongest evidence of scheme outcome?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Budget announcement.
- B. Cabinet approval.
- C. Beneficiary registration.
- D. A measured change attributable to the intervention after accounting for baseline and comparison.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- EXPLANATION: A measured change attributable to the intervention after accounting for baseline and comparison.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 29 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about millets is most balanced?

STATIC THEORY

- A. They offer dryland, nutrition and climate benefits in suitable systems but need markets and processing.
- B. They can replace every crop everywhere.
- C. They require flooded fields.
- D. They are excluded from cereals.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- EXPLANATION: They offer dryland, nutrition and climate benefits in suitable systems but need markets and processing.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 30 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which best defines water productivity?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Yield per hectare only.
- B. Output or value/nutrition per stated unit of water; denominator and scale must be specified.
- C. Canal length.
- D. Rainfall total.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- EXPLANATION: Output or value/nutrition per stated unit of water; denominator and scale must be specified.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A -> B -> C -> D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 31 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about official estimates is correct?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Advance means final.
- B. Final estimates never reconcile.
- C. Advance estimates may be revised; the release stage and date must travel with the number.
- D. All portals update simultaneously.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- EXPLANATION: Advance estimates may be revised; the release stage and date must travel with the number.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A → B → C → D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Economic Geography →
Agriculture

HIGH**Hard MCQ 32 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which answer structure best earns Geography marks?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Scheme list only.
- B. Unlabelled statistics.
- C. A generic conclusion.
- D. Claim → named spatial evidence → mechanism → qualification → reasoned verdict.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- EXPLANATION: Claim → named spatial evidence → mechanism → qualification → reasoned verdict.
- ELIMINATION: The remaining options either conflate categories, omit the binding mechanism or turn a conditional relationship into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation A → B → C → D.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose the longest option.

CORRECT: Verify mechanism and qualification.

MAINS ANGLE

Topic-complete objective practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography → Economic Geography →
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 1 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Which statement best separates intensive from commercial farming?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Intensive concerns input/output per unit land, while commercial concerns market orientation.
- B. Both are climatic classifications.
- C. Commercial always means extensive.
- D. Intensive always means mechanised.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- REMEDIATION: Intensive concerns input/output per unit land, while commercial concerns market orientation.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 2 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Which condition most directly steepens a Von Thunen rent gradient?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Lower perishability.
- B. High transport cost or rapid quality decay per unit distance.
- C. Many substitute markets.
- D. Uniform fertility.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- REMEDIATION: High transport cost or rapid quality decay per unit distance.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 3 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Boserup's central claim is best expressed as:

STATIC THEORY

- A. Technology is unrelated to labour.
- B. Land abundance automatically raises yields.
- C. Population pressure can induce intensification under enabling institutional and technical conditions.
- D. Population growth always reduces output.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- REMEDIATION: Population pressure can induce intensification under enabling institutional and technical conditions.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 4 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Which is an operational holding?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Every parcel in one village.
- B. Only irrigated land.
- C. Only legally owned land.
- D. All land operated as one technical unit for agricultural production, regardless of ownership mix.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- REMEDIATION: All land operated as one technical unit for agricultural production, regardless of ownership mix.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 5 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Which comparison is correct?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Market gardening is often peri-urban; truck farming can serve distant markets through transport.
- B. Market gardening excludes vegetables.
- C. Truck farming is nomadic.
- D. Both are subsistence systems.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- REMEDIATION: Market gardening is often peri-urban; truck farming can serve distant markets through transport.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 6 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Which is the strongest groundwater-energy nexus explanation?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Deeper water lowers energy use.
- B. Low marginal pumping cost encourages extraction from a shared aquifer, raising future lift and energy needs.
- C. Every well draws an isolated stock.
- D. Power subsidy directly recharges aquifers.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- REMEDIATION: Low marginal pumping cost encourages extraction from a shared aquifer, raising future lift and energy needs.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 7 - Correct key: CGS-I & GS-III
Geography**NEWS TRIGGER**

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: What does a crop calendar add to annual climate averages?

STATIC THEORY

- A. A fixed national sowing date.
- B. Only soil texture.
- C. Stage-specific exposure to sowing moisture, flowering heat, frost, flood and harvest rain.
- D. Only market price.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- REMEDIATION: Stage-specific exposure to sowing moisture, flowering heat, frost, flood and harvest rain.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS**WRONG:** Repeat the original error.**CORRECT:** State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.**MAINS ANGLE***Remedial practice.***STUDY LINK**Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 8 - Correct key: DGS-I & GS-III
Geography**NEWS TRIGGER**

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Which is not a synonym of the other two?

STATIC THEORY

- A. All prohibit synthetic input in every design.
- B. All require certification.
- C. All prohibit tillage.
- D. Organic, natural and conservation agriculture are distinct frameworks with partial overlap.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- REMEDIATION: Organic, natural and conservation agriculture are distinct frameworks with partial overlap.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography -> Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 9 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Which chain is statistically valid?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Area x yield approximately relates to production, subject to harvested area, units and official reconciliation.
- B. MSP equals market arrival.
- C. Stock equals consumption.
- D. Production equals procurement.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- REMEDIATION: Area x yield approximately relates to production, subject to harvested area, units and official reconciliation.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 10 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Why can micro-irrigation fail to save basin water?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Efficiency has no physical meaning.
- B. Farmers may expand irrigated area or shift to more water-intensive crops.
- C. Sprinklers always cause salinity.
- D. Drip cannot deliver water.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- REMEDIATION: Farmers may expand irrigated area or shift to more water-intensive crops.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 11 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: What is the best test of e-NAM impact?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Number of listed commodities alone.
- B. Number of app downloads.
- C. Completed competitive trade with credible assaying, settlement and farmer price/cost outcomes.
- D. Farmer registration alone.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- REMEDIATION: Completed competitive trade with credible assaying, settlement and farmer price/cost outcomes.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 12 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Which is correctly paired?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Cereals: includes gram.
- B. Oilseeds: part of pulses.
- C. Foodgrains: rice and wheat only.
- D. Foodgrains: cereals plus pulses; oilseeds: separate official aggregate.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- REMEDIATION: Foodgrains: cereals plus pulses; oilseeds: separate official aggregate.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 13 - Correct key: A**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Which best explains plantation geography?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Crop ecology plus estate labour, processing, capital and port/export history.
- B. Absence of market links.
- C. Subsistence destination.
- D. Perennial life cycle alone.
- CORRECT KEY: A
- REMEDIATION: Crop ecology plus estate labour, processing, capital and port/export history.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 14 - Correct key: B**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Which statement about shifting cultivation is balanced?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It is a plantation system.
- B. Outcome depends on fallow length, slope, crop diversity, tenure and fire management.
- C. It is always destructive.
- D. It is always sustainable.
- CORRECT KEY: B
- REMEDIATION: Outcome depends on fallow length, slope, crop diversity, tenure and fire management.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 15 - Correct key: C**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: Why is procurement geography narrower than production geography?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Production requires a warehouse.
- B. MSP is announced for one district.
- C. Agency operations, crop concentration, quality, infrastructure and state capacity vary spatially.
- D. Only one state produces grain.
- CORRECT KEY: C
- REMEDIATION: Agency operations, crop concentration, quality, infrastructure and state capacity vary spatially.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 16 - Correct key: D**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial variant: What does climate-smart agriculture denote?

STATIC THEORY

- A. A ban on irrigation.
- B. Only genetically modified seed.
- C. One certification standard.
- D. A context-specific objective of productivity, adaptation/resilience and mitigation where feasible.
- CORRECT KEY: D
- REMEDIATION: A context-specific objective of productivity, adaptation/resilience and mitigation where feasible.
- ERROR TARGET: category conflation, status inflation, missing spatial scale or absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continues the global A -> B -> C -> D sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Repeat the original error.

CORRECT: State why the distractor is overbroad or category-wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

Remedial practice.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Original Mains practice - 10 marks**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

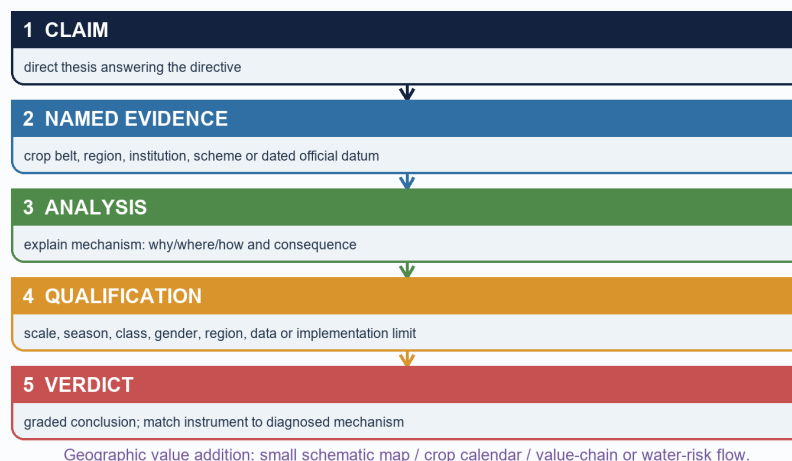
INTRO & ORIGIN

Examine the continuing relevance of Von Thunen for peri-urban agriculture in India.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE - 10 MARKS

UPSC Agriculture Answer Spine

Schematic; not to scale



Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Agricultural-marketing performance depends on functions, competition and infrastructure rather than the legal identity of the intermediary.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: e-NAM demonstrates digital price discovery but still requires assaying, logistics and settlement. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FPOs aggregate small lots and bargaining power but need working capital and governance. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Warehouse receipts and cold chains reduce distress sale and quality loss when accredited and connected. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: A large private buyer can replace a commission agent yet reproduce monopsony and quality-dispute risk.
- VERDICT: Reform should combine market choice, trusted grading, farmer aggregation, finance, logistics and enforceable contracts.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Directive and word-limit proportionality required.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Evidence list without inference.**CORRECT:** After each example state what it proves.

MAINS ANGLE

Full model solution.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH

Original Mains practice - 10 marks

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

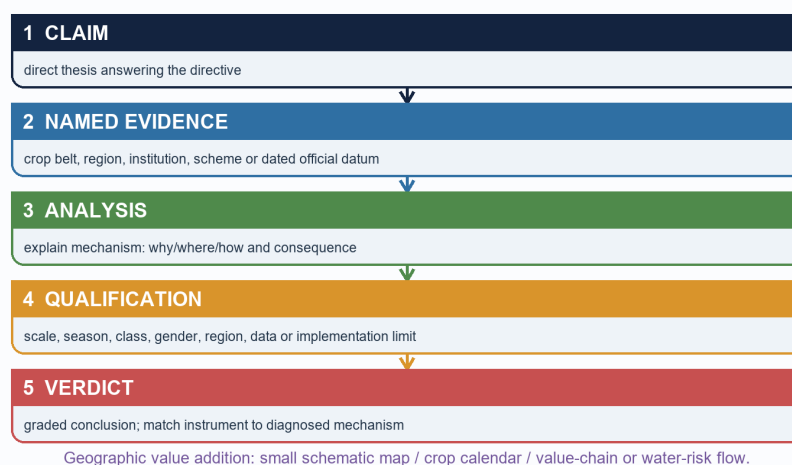
INTRO & ORIGIN

Explain why an increase in irrigation potential need not produce reliable and sustainable irrigation.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE - 10 MARKS

UPSC Agriculture Answer Spine

Schematic; not to scale



Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: India's agricultural water crisis is a source-distribution-application-drainage-governance problem, not only a shortage of projects.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: PMKSY separates access, efficiency and watershed/command functions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Drip/sprinkler can raise plot efficiency; basin saving depends on rebound. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Watershed ridge-to-valley treatment supports recharge and protective irrigation. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: The groundwater-power nexus in north-western and hard-rock regions shows shared-stock externality. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Potential created or area covered does not prove reliable, equitable and sustainable irrigation.
- VERDICT: Combine aquifer budgeting, crop-water alignment, energy reform, canal maintenance, drainage and participatory allocation.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Directive and word-limit proportionality required.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Evidence list without inference.

CORRECT: After each example state what it proves.

MAINS ANGLE

Full model solution.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->

Agriculture

HIGH**Original Mains practice - 15 marks**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

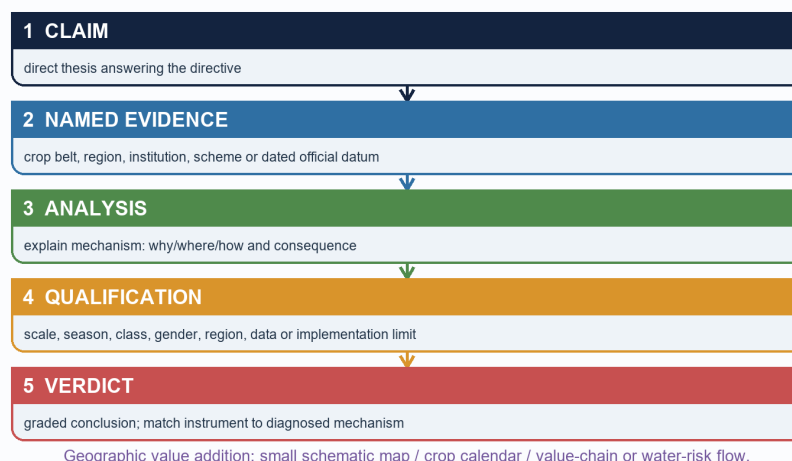
Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Analyse how land tenure, water, procurement and cold-chain geography jointly shape crop choice in India.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE - 15 MARKS**UPSC Agriculture Answer Spine**

Schematic; not to scale



Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Agricultural-marketing performance depends on functions, competition and infrastructure rather than the legal identity of the intermediary.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: e-NAM demonstrates digital price discovery but still requires assaying, logistics and settlement. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FPOs aggregate small lots and bargaining power but need working capital and governance. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Warehouse receipts and cold chains reduce distress sale and quality loss when accredited and connected. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: A large private buyer can replace a commission agent yet reproduce monopsony and quality-dispute risk.
- VERDICT: Reform should combine market choice, trusted grading, farmer aggregation, finance, logistics and enforceable contracts.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Directive and word-limit proportionality required.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Evidence list without inference.

CORRECT: After each example state what it proves.

MAINS ANGLE

Full model solution.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Original Mains practice - 15 marks**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

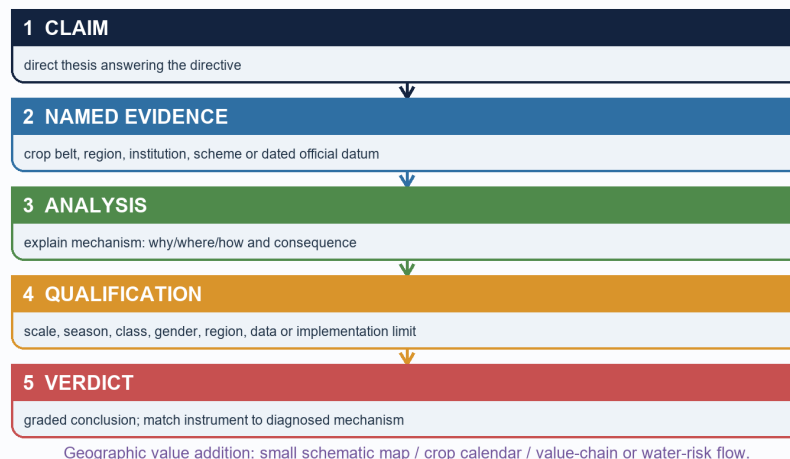
INTRO & ORIGIN

Critically examine the regional diffusion and second-generation challenges of the Green Revolution.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE - 15 MARKS

UPSC Agriculture Answer Spine

Schematic; not to scale



Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Agricultural transformation emerged from complementary engineering, crop science and state institutions.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Visvesvaraya's automatic sluice gates and block irrigation illustrate systematic water engineering. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Swaminathan's role in adapting semi-dwarf wheat/rice links global germplasm to Indian agronomy. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Punjab-Haryana-western UP show the package of water, fertiliser, credit, extension and procurement. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Success was regionally selective and generated groundwater, nutrient and crop-lock-in costs.
- VERDICT: Retain research and state capacity while shifting to diversified, resource-aligned and rainfed productivity.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 15 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Directive and word-limit proportionality required.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Evidence list without inference.**CORRECT:** After each example state what it proves.

MAINS ANGLE

Full model solution.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH

Original Mains practice - 20 marks

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

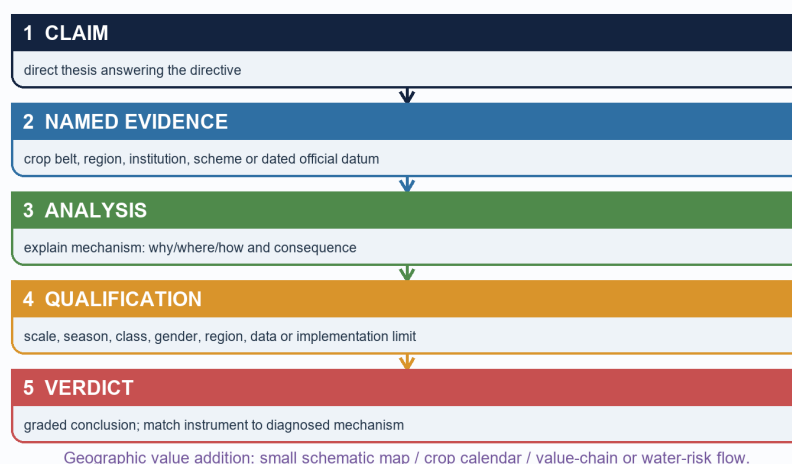
INTRO & ORIGIN

Agricultural transformation must move from output maximisation to resilient value creation. Discuss with reference to rainfed systems, markets, digital agriculture and a just transition.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE - 20 MARKS

UPSC Agriculture Answer Spine

Schematic; not to scale



Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Ecological farming can reduce external input and soil-water pressure while creating differentiated transition costs.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Sikkim provides a named whole-state organic-policy example. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: NPOP/PGS-type certification distinguishes standard-based organic from generic low-input practice. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Diversified rotations, manure and biological processes can improve soil functions. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Certification, market premium and lower chemical use do not guarantee yield, income or zero externality in every crop and season.
- VERDICT: Phase transitions with extension, local nutrient plans, markets and outcome monitoring.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 3 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 20 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Directive and word-limit proportionality required.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Evidence list without inference.

CORRECT: After each example state what it proves.

MAINS ANGLE

Full model solution.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

HIGH**Original Mains practice - 20 marks**

GS-I & GS-III
Geography

NEWS TRIGGER

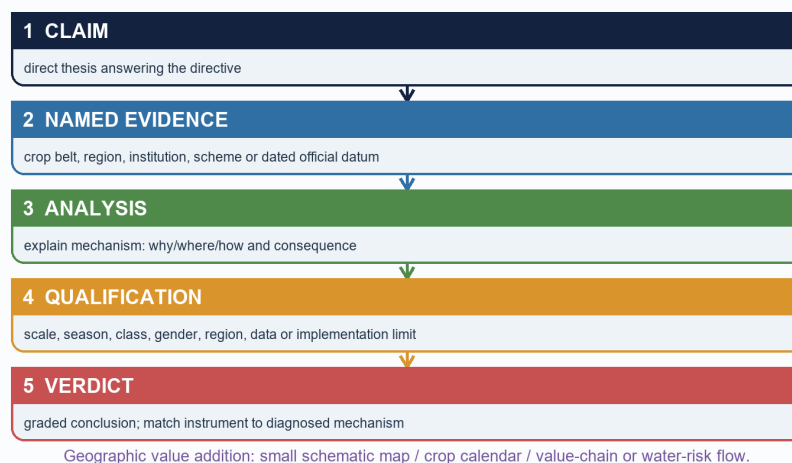
Evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026. Facts are source-grounded; analytical claims are qualified.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Evaluate India's food-security geography from production and procurement to stocks, PDS, trade and nutrition.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE - 20 MARKS**UPSC Agriculture Answer Spine**

Schematic; not to scale



Original deterministic topic-specific visual; schematic and not a source of volatile data.

AI-generated illustration - conceptual visual, not factual evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- CLAIM: Food security requires availability, access, utilisation and stability; procurement and PDS are linked but distinct institutions.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: FCI/state procurement converts surplus into central-pool stocks. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: NFSA/TPDS creates a legal entitlement channel. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: ONORC/digitisation improve portability and auditability. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- NAMED EVIDENCE / EXAMPLE: Buffer stocks support emergencies and price management. ANALYSIS: This evidence proves a mechanism rather than serving as a decorative fact.
- QUALIFICATION: Cereal access cannot alone solve nutrition, exclusion, storage loss or ecological production costs.
- VERDICT: Improve dynamic coverage, grievance routes, storage, diversified baskets and transparent stock-release rules.
- WHY THIS EARNS MARKS: It answers the directive, uses 4 named evidence units, explains spatial or institutional mechanisms, qualifies the claim and closes with a graded verdict appropriate to 20 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Directive and word-limit proportionality required.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Evidence list without inference.

CORRECT: After each example state what it proves.

MAINS ANGLE

Full model solution.

STUDY LINK

Geography -> Economic Geography ->
Agriculture

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI